

Blackberry owners rejoice

Canadian company RIM opens up the Blackberry app store for India situation.



4G

Transceiver chip maker Infineon ties up with Nokia to work on the next generation of 4G mobile phones

of major botnets. Botnets are computers that are captured by spammers, and used as a proxy for sending large number of mails and bypassing normal system checks to restrict the number of connections from a single computer.

All those viruses that don't really seem to do anything to your computer, and all those infected USB drives are not just giving users a hard time. Their intention is to spread from computer to computer, and form a part of a botnet that can be used for various purposes. This points to very loose, and outdated security when it comes to computers in India. Symantec however, notes that the trend could largely be because of the spread of internet and broadband infrastructure in India.

Thankfully, India does not feature as prominently on the phishing part of the report. India comes in ninth place. What is disturbing however, is that almost all the Phishing scams in India are related to Banking. India is a very susceptible target for Phishing attacks, because of the lack of net-savviness in many people who bank online, and because online banking has just started off.

On the brighter side, the full spectrum of banking services are not yet offered online by many banks, and people have not yet adopted using the online services of banks that do. There are indications that Indian users are going to leap frog over desktop based online banking, and directly head out into mobile banking, which is a much more secure approach.

However, if you do bank online, we encourage you

to check the URL of every banking site carefully before entering any personal details. You can download the Symantec reports from <http://www.thinkdigit.com/d/sispr>.

Worldwide Grid launched by CERN

The organisation that gave us the world wide web has put the internet to good use again by deploying the biggest ever grid till date. A grid is the exact opposite of a cloud, where data is processed simultaneously on individual computers, after it is distributed to them,

unravelling protein structures to weather forecasting.

Although CERN and associated organisations spent \$6 billion on the LHC, the amount of data that the collider would churn out once it was operational was immense – around 15 petabytes a year. Processing this data would be immensely expensive. Apart from that, relying on traditional super-computer architecture to process the data would be time consuming as well. Grid computing distributes all this data to machines located around the world, reducing the oper-



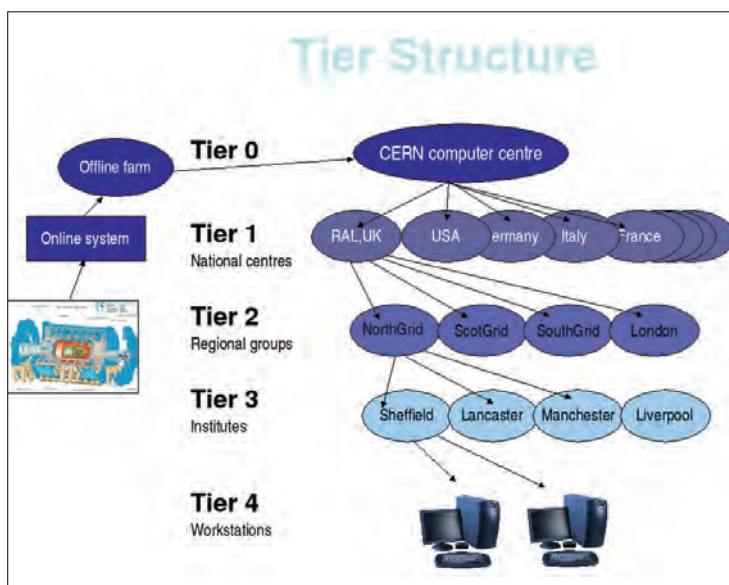
Call of Duty: Modern Warfare 2

data processing to more computers located close to these nodes. The most active is Atlas, with nodes mostly in the universities of the United States. Europe hosts most of the nodes in the CMS set, with two nodes in India.

Russia bans COD

Careless censorship has been a problem that most popular culture items have faced time and again. The latest victim of policing is Infinity Ward's *Call of Duty: Modern Warfare 2*, with Russia recalling all copies of the game from stores. The reason, of course, is the controversial 'No Russian' level in the game, which depicts the player and a few Russian terrorists opening fire on civilians in an airport.

The airport level is obviously a publicity stunt by Infinity Ward in order to raise more word-of-mouth publicity about the game. There have been online comments and blogs that call Russia's game recall as being hypersensitive and hypocritical. The biggest reason for this is that the game is set in current times using the name 'Russia', and does not depict a historical or fictitious context like in previous Call of Duty games. **d**



The world's largest Grid, used for processing the terrabytes of LHC data



For a more detailed report, camp at <http://www.thinkdigit.com/d/mw2>



instead of centrally, on servers with a high processing power.

Grid computing in itself is not a new idea, and has been used by scientific projects on a large scale before. One of the earliest and widest known implementation of grid computing was Seti@home. Since then, scientists have used the grid for everything from

ating cost, putting more processors to work at the same time, and providing a fail safe backup for all the data.

CERN's grid uses high-bandwidth (10 Gbps) fibre-optic cables, to eight important nodes located around the world. There are four sets of nodes around the world that distribute the